全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 1 單元 | 人物與外貌描述 · People & Descriptions

The Most Energetic Man in Our Alley

我們巷子裡最有活力的人

Every morning at five thirty, long before the first MRT train leaves the station, my grandfather is already in the park doing tai chi. He is seventy-eight years old and almost completely bald, but nobody in our alley would ever call him 'old'. Elderly neighbors who are ten years younger than he is often ask him how he stays so energetic. His answer is always the same: 'Keep moving, and keep listening.'

Grandpa was born into a poor family in Yunlin, a background he never hides. He left school at fourteen and spent forty hard-working years repairing scooters in a tiny shop near the night market. Because he was so dependable, customers who had moved to Taichung still rode back to let him fix their bikes. Although he has become slightly forgetful lately, he never forgets a name or a face. He greets the courteous young clerk at the convenience store, the lively children on their way to school, and even the junior police officer who once gave him a parking ticket.

What I admire most, however, is his generosity. When a neighbor's son could not afford cram school, Grandpa quietly paid the fee for a whole year. He is considerate in small ways too, always carrying an extra umbrella in case someone is caught in the rain. A gifted storyteller, he can make a crowd of grown-ups laugh with tales of the old days, yet he is also a patient listener who lets even the shyest child finish a sentence.

In a world where influential people are usually rich or famous, my grandfather has shown me that the most capable leaders are often the ones who interact kindly with everyone around them. I hope that when I am his age, people will still be asking me how I stay so young.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
elderly	*adj.*	年長的	The elderly man walks in the park every morning. 那位年長的先生每天早上在公園散步。

bald	*adj.*	禿頭的	My uncle started going bald in his thirties. 我叔叔三十幾歲就開始禿頭了。
energetic	*adj.*	精力充沛的	The energetic puppy ran around the yard for an hour. 那隻精力充沛的小狗在院子裡跑了一個小時。
dependable	*adj.*	可靠的	Lisa is dependable, so she was chosen as class leader. 麗莎很可靠，所以被選為班長。
forgetful	*adj.*	健忘的	I am so forgetful that I left my phone on the bus again. 我健忘到又把手機忘在公車上了。
courteous	*adj.*	有禮貌的	The courteous waiter pulled out the chair for her. 那位有禮貌的服務生替她拉開椅子。
generosity	*n.*	慷慨	Thanks to his generosity, the library got new computers. 多虧他的慷慨，圖書館有了新電腦。
considerate	*adj.*	體貼的	It was considerate of you to save me a seat. 你幫我留位子真是體貼。
gifted	*adj.*	有天分的	The gifted student finished the test in ten minutes. 那位有天分的學生十分鐘就寫完考卷。
influential	*adj.*	有影響力的	She is one of the most influential writers in Taiwan. 她是台灣最有影響力的作家之一。

片語 Phrases

be born into	出生於（某種家庭）	He was born into a family of doctors. 他出生在一個醫生世家。
in case	以防萬一	Take a jacket in case it gets cold tonight. 帶件外套，以防今晚變冷。
be caught in the rain	被雨淋到	We were caught in the rain on our way home. 我們在回家的路上被雨淋到了。

文法與句型 Grammar

Although + S + V, S + V

「雖然…，但是…」。Although 引導讓步子句，注意中文的「但是」在英文裡不能再加 but。

Although he is eighty, he still rides a scooter.

雖然他八十歲了，仍然騎機車。

What + S + V + is + N / 名詞子句

What 引導的名詞子句當主詞，意思是「…的事物／事情」，常用來強調重點。

What I admire most is his generosity.

我最佩服的是他的慷慨。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。